

Sarvnipun Kaur

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Research Interests

Applied microeconomics focused on law, policy design, and labour market institutions.

Education

Ph.D. in Economics , Plaksha University	Aug 2022 – Present
Occasional Ph.D. Student, Imperial College London	Jan 2026–Present
M.Phil. in Economics , Panjab University	2021
Dissertation: <i>Pattern of Economic Development of Indian States: A Comparative Analysis of Punjab and Haryana</i>	
M.A. in Economics , Panjab University	2018
B.Com. (Honours) , Jesus and Mary College, University of Delhi	2015

Working Papers

- Kaur, Sarvnipun; Singh, Prakarsh; Arora, Anshika. *Cinderella No More: Night Shift Bans and Women's Employment in India*. September 2025.
Working Paper.
- Kaur, Sarvnipun; Singh, Prakarsh; Arora, Anshika. *Engaging Demand: Teaching Microeconomics in a Virtual Class*. August 2023.
Available at SSRN.

Work in Progress

- *Unintended Consequences of Gender Equal Pay: Evidence from Wimbledon* (with Prakarsh Singh).
 - Measures effort responses to changes in prize structure using match-level data of performance and ability and a Difference-in-Differences methodology.
- Employment Protection Design and Firm Litigation: Evidence from Gujarat.
 - Uses spatial variation in labor law within Gujarat to test whether the design of employment protection legislation shapes firm litigation.
- Dismantling Dismissal Protection: Evidence from Indian Plant-Level Data (with Prakarsh Singh and Saurabh Gupta).
 - Uses plant-level Annual Survey of Industries panel data and staggered difference-in-differences across reforming states to estimate how removing dismissal protections and increasing severance reshapes employment and employee wage in firms of different sizes.

- *Front-Loaded vs. Back-Loaded Incentives: Experimental Evidence.*
 - Lab experiments to test theoretical predictions on incentive timing and their effects on effort, persistence, and performance.

Publications and Reports

In Press / Reports

- Anand, Bhuvana; Bomjan, Baishali; Kaur, Sarvniapun. “The Curious Case of Indian Working Women.” *LiveMint* (March 8, 2022) [Link].
- Kaur, Sarvniapun; Singh, Abhishek. “No Cabaret, Crooning or Cocktails: How Laws Impact Women in India’s Hospitality Industry.” *ThePrint* (March 13, 2022) [Link].
- Anand, Bhuvana; Kaur, Sarvniapun; Kaur, Sargun (2020). “Labour pains: Status check on reforms in employment protection legislation.” In *Regulation for New Realities: A Cross-Sectoral Analysis during COVID-19*, pp. 47–68. Centre for Civil Society [Link].
- Anand, Bhuvana; Kaur, Sarvniapun (2022). “State of Discrimination Report: A sub-national comparison of legal barriers to women’s right to choose work in India.” [Link]
- Anand, Bhuvana; Kaur, Sarvniapun. “What can we expect from the labour codes?” Teamlease RegTech Blog (November 18, 2021) [Link].

Teaching Experience

Teaching Assistant, Plaksha University

- Undergraduate modules: Microeconomics, Experimental Economics, Environmental Economics.

Guest Faculty, Panjab University

- Introductory Microeconomics, Introductory Macroeconomics, Indian Economic Issues I.

Presentations

- European Sports Economics Association (ESEA), University of Zurich (August 2026)
- NBER Summer Institute, Gender in the Economy (July 2026)
- Royal Economic Society (RES), Newcastle University, UK (June 2026).
- LEO Economics Conference, Plaksha University (April 2026).
- Annual Conference on Economic Growth and Development (ACEGD), Indian Statistical Institute, Delhi (December 2025).
- PhD Colloquium, Indira Gandhi Institute of Development Research (IGIDR), Mumbai (October 2025).
- LEO Economics Conference, Plaksha University (April 2025).
- Chandigarh Social Science Congress VII (CHASSCONG), Chandigarh (2017): “Right to Elementary Education: An Effectiveness, Efficiency and Economy Evaluation.”

Fellowships, Honors, and Awards

- Plaksha International Fellowship (2025).
- JPAL Research for Impact Fellowship (2023).
- Plaksha Research Fellowship (2022).
- UGC-NET (Eligibility for Lectureship), India (2017).

Skills

Software: R, Stata, L^AT_EX